

Models in depth

LESSON 01 · EQUIP & CONNECT – STUDIO: TOOLS, MODELS & MCP

What you'll learn

- Choose the right model for an agent based on four parameters: speed, cost, context window, and reasoning capability.
- Navigate the Compare Models dashboard to evaluate and sort different hosted or custom model offerings.
- Set up a fallback model chain under Connections to ensure service continuity in case of primary provider outages.
- Fine-tune reasoning effort settings (low, medium, high) on reasoning-heavy models to balance output quality against latency and cost.

Key concepts

The model is the agent's brain and your primary reasoning lever.

Every decision an agent makes, from tool-selection to natural language formatting, depends on the underlying LLM. Choosing the right model dictates the response latency, cost, and overall intelligence of the system.

TAKEAWAY

The model is the agent's brain and your primary reasoning lever.

Compare Models is your evaluation center for speed, cost, context, and reasoning. Instead of guessing or hardcoding, Studio provides a side-by-side dashboard where you can filter by provider (OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, etc.) and sort based on what your application prioritizes.

TAKEAWAY

Compare Models is your evaluation center for speed, cost, context, and reasoning.

Most agent builds fall into three model profiles: fast, high-reasoning, or balanced. Fast models are best for real-time customer chats where low latency is critical; high-reasoning models excel at complex background tasks where a slow but deep response is acceptable; balanced models serve as the standard middle ground.

TAKEAWAY

Most agent builds fall into three model profiles: fast, high-reasoning, or balanced.

Never ship to production without setting up a model fallback chain.

Models and provider endpoints experience outages. Configuring a chain under Connections ensures that if your primary model fails, the next swappable brain takes over automatically, preventing agent downtime.

TAKEAWAY

Never ship to production without setting up a model fallback chain.

Reasoning effort settings let you tune the trade-off between thought depth and cost. For reasoning models, Studio exposes low, medium, and high settings. Low is fast and economical, while High tells the model to think harder before responding, which is ideal for complex, multi-variable logic.

TAKEAWAY

Reasoning effort settings let you tune the trade-off between thought depth and cost.

In Studio

Studio feature: **Compare Models** and **Connections → Models**. Here's how to configure and optimize your agent's reasoning engine:

1. Open your agent in **Agent Studio** and locate the **Model** selector dropdown under the agent's primary configuration block.
2. Click **Compare Models** on the left navigation panel. Inspect the comparison table containing speed, cost, context, and reasoning metrics.
3. Filter by provider or sort by speed/cost to find the model that fits your performance and budget target.
4. Go to the **Connections** tab, select **Models**, and click **Configure Fallback Chain**. Add one or two backup models in order of priority.
5. In the agent's advanced parameters, toggle **Reasoning Effort** (Low, Medium, High) to dial in the reasoning level for reasoning-capable models.
6. Click **Save** to lock in your swappable brain and fallback setup.

TRY THIS

- 1** Open **Compare Models** and sort by speed. Identify the fastest model on the list. Then, sort by cost and find the cheapest model.
- 2** Go to **Connections → Models** and configure a fallback chain with at least two backup models.
- 3** Switch your agent's brain from a fast model to a high-reasoning model and verify that the instructions, knowledge, and tools remain unchanged.